



WAM

PRESIDENT OFFERS CONDOLENCES TO UMM AL QUWAIN RULER

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday offered his condolences to His Highness Shaikh Saud Bin Rashid Al Mualla, Supreme Council Member and Ruler of Umm Al Quwain, on the passing of his mother Shaikha Hessa Bint Hamid Bin Abdul Rahman Al Shamsi. Shaikh Mohammad was accompanied by Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Chairman of the Presidential Court for Special Affairs, along with a number of senior officials.

322 children killed in Gaza in 10 days: UN

MOST OF THEM WERE IN MAKESHIFT TENTS OR DAMAGED HOMES

UNITED NATIONS

Israel's renewed offensive in Gaza has reportedly left at least 322 children dead and 609 wounded in the Palestinian territory in the past 10 days, Unicef has said. The figures include children who were reportedly killed or wounded when the surgical department of Al Nasser Hospital, in southern Gaza, was hit in an attack on March 23, the UN children's agency said in a statement. Unicef said most of these children were displaced, and sheltering in makeshift tents or damaged homes. Ending a nearly two-month ceasefire in the war with Hamas, Israel resumed intense bombing of Gaza on March 18 and then launched a new ground offensive. "The ceasefire in Gaza provided a desperately needed lifeline for Gaza's children and hope for a path to recovery," said Unicef Executive Director Catherine Russell. "But children have again been plunged into a cycle of deadly violence and deprivation." Russell added: "All parties must adhere to their obligations under international humanitarian law to protect children." The Unicef statement said

ISRAEL KILLS HEZBOLLAH OFFICIAL IN BEIRUT

A Hezbollah official was among four people killed yesterday in an Israeli strike on south Beirut, Israel and a Hezbollah source said, the second such raid during a fragile four-month ceasefire. Lebanon's leaders condemned the attack, which came without warning at around 3.30am (0030 GMT) during the Eid Al Fitr holiday. It struck after Israel on Friday raided Beirut's southern suburbs — a stronghold of Lebanon's Iran-backed Hezbollah armed group — after issuing an evacuation warning. A source close to Hezbollah, requesting anonymity as they were not authorised to brief the media, told AFP the strike killed Hassan Bdair, Hezbollah's "deputy head for the Palestinian file" who was "at home with his family". Israel's military confirmed it killed Bdair in a joint statement with the Shin Bet domestic security agency. The statement said Bdair "recently operated in cooperation with the Hamas terrorist organisation, directed Hamas terrorists, and assisted them in planning and advancing a significant and imminent terror attack against Israeli civilians".

— AFP

that after nearly 18 months of war, more than 15,000 children have reportedly been killed, over 34,000 reportedly injured, and nearly one million children have been displaced repeatedly and denied basic services. Medical attention Unicef called for an end to hostilities and for Israel to end its ban on humanitarian aid entering Gaza, which has been in force since March 2. It also said children who are sick or wounded should be

evacuated to receive medical attention. "Food, safe water, shelter, and medical care have become increasingly scarce. Without these essential supplies, malnutrition, diseases and other preventable conditions will likely surge, leading to an increase in preventable child deaths," Unicef said. "The world must not stand by and allow the killing and suffering of children to continue," it added.

— AFP

Gold shoppers swap old for new as rates soar

22K gold briefly crosses Dh350 for the first time in UAE

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Gold shoppers in the UAE are adapting swiftly as 22K gold now costs Dh350 per gram for the first time ever. With prices climbing nearly Dh30 in the past month, many are turning to

exchange offers rather than purchasing new jewellery. Retailers report 'fairly decent' demand during Eid, with customers swapping high-value pieces for multiple smaller items or gold bars. Maximise returns Tourists, particularly from India and Pakistan, are leveraging the price difference and favourable exchange rates to maximise returns. Saudi and GCC visitors are also making strategic trades, ben-

efiting from VAT refunds and price variations. With Saudi's 15 per cent VAT compared to the UAE's 5 per cent, many tourists see an opportunity to recover costs on previous purchases. Despite rising prices, promotions on making charges are keeping trade active. Uncertainty remains over gold's next move, but shoppers are hedging their bets, treating jewellery as both an investment and a financial safeguard for the future.

SEE ALSO P6

Trump plans UAE visit next month

This will be US President's first overseas trip since returning to power

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

US President Donald Trump may visit the UAE and Saudi Arabia as soon as next month, he told reporters at the White House yesterday, in what could be his first overseas trip since his return to power. "It could be next month, maybe a little bit later. And we're going to Qatar, also, and also we're going to possibly a couple of other countries. UAE is very important ... so we'll probably stop at UAE and Qatar," the Republican said. He said Saudi officials had agreed to "spend close to a trillion dollars ... in our American companies, which to me means jobs." The US companies will be

making equipment for Saudi Arabia and other places in the Middle East, the president continued, adding: "And for that, I think it's worth it."

\$600b Saudi pledge

In January, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammad Bin Salman promised to pile \$600 billion into US trade and investments. "I view it as jobs more than anything else, and now we're close to a trillion dollars," Trump said. "So it's more than double the number that we did when I first came to office." Trump notably did not mention the Saudi role in hosting negotiations over a possible summit with Russian President Vladimir Putin over the war with Ukraine. The US president has previously indicated the pair could hold talks there, but has expressed frustration in recent days. Earlier, Trump said he remained confident Putin would eventually back a ceasefire deal.

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